MONTHLY UPDATE

Mali: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · DATA

Summary of the month

The transition president inaugurated a centre for artificial intelligence and robotics at Kati Sirakoro Niare on 21 September. The telecoms regulators of the three confederation states signed a cooperation convention, reported on 26 September. The data protection authority signed a cooperation agreement with Togo's on 23 September and presented its regional offices to Benin's authority on 4 September. An AI provider's September misuse report disclosed a domestic surveillance platform named Lakana 360.

Governance

Data protection

The largest privacy fact of the month came from outside the country. A model provider's threat report says a consultant working with the state security agency used its AI model to build Lakana 360, a platform monitoring about 25 million SIM cards across all three mobile operators and capturing call records, messages and voice traffic, with a warrant requirement removed from one component. No Malian authority's response or legal basis for the interception is on record.

The authority's cooperation with Benin produced its first recorded joint action: Benin's First Rapporteur visited on 4 September for an exchange on compliance tools, regulatory standards, communication and Mali's regional offices at Kayes, Sikasso, Ségou and Mopti. No joint instrument or work plan from it is on record.

On 23 September the authority signed a cooperation agreement with Togo's personal-data authority providing for information exchange, cooperation on complaints handling and compliance checks, and staff training; the talks also covered cross-border data transfers, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence.

Regional collaboration

The Burkinabè, Malian and Nigerien telecommunications regulators signed a cooperation convention creating a Council of Sahel Regulators, reported on 26 September, covering free roaming, frequency coordination at the borders, mutual recognition of type-approved equipment and coordinated 5G introduction; its statutes and first work programme are still to be adopted. They had announced the signing on 23 September.

The communication ministry convened digital and media actors on 2 September to weigh a common confederation framework for regulating social media, with a reference text developed in Burkina Faso put forward as the model. The West African body's page for its regional fibre infrastructure programme is held as at September 2026. The country withdrew from the body in January 2025, and nothing on the page says what that leaves of its participation.

Standards

The standards agency's fourteenth ordinary board session balanced a 2026 budget of CFA 243,306,303 against CFA 318,369,036 in 2025, a fall of about a quarter, and it holds a correspondent member profile with the international standards organisation. The agency was created by ordinance in March 2012; no standard adopted, certification issued or staffing figure is published.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The cybercrime tribunal sentenced the publication director of Le Témoin to two years in prison on 14 September, over a remark about Kidal made on television in June; the defence intends to appeal.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The Senegalese and Malian state fibre operators inaugurated the interconnection of their national backbones at the Kidira-Diboli border crossing.

DPI

Sectoral management information systems

The national health information system publishes its own description — case detection, the launch of interventions to prevent transmission and reduce morbidity, and the surveillance behind them, running under a health and social information strategic plan for 2020-2024 whose period has expired and a national digital health plan for 2024-2028.

The education ministry validated the specification and mock-up of a portal to manage teacher postings and attendance, under a project funded by the European Union and run by NGOs. No build contract or launch date is stated.

Technology

AI

The transition president inaugurated a centre for artificial intelligence and robotics on 21 September 2026 on a 50-hectare site at Kati Sirakoro Niare, with teaching facilities, dormitories and a fabrication and assembly workshop, financed from the national budget at FCFA 3.3bn.

Capacity

Training and skills

The youth digital skills convention delivered its first cohort of 1,000, in bursaried four-month training toward a target of 15,000 over three years.

Data

National statistics

The Council of Ministers took note on 9 October 2026 of the fourth Schéma Directeur de la Statistique and its action plan for 2026 to 2030, on a written communication from the economy and finance minister. It sets four axes: management of the national statistical system, its capacity, statistical production, and analysis with modernised dissemination and use. The text is not held.

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